

Sinner Makes History: Five Straight Masters Titles and Counting

From: BBC Tennis Mined: 2026-05-04 5 min read

Jannik Sinner is rewriting the tennis record books. On Sunday, the world number one dismantled Alexander Zverev 6-1, 6-2 in the Madrid Open final, securing an unprecedented fifth consecutive **Masters 1000** title. The Italian needed just 58 minutes to dispatch the two-time Madrid champion, never facing a **break point** and converting all four he earned.

Sinner's run is historic. He surpassed Novak Djokovic and Rafael Nadal, who each managed four straight Masters titles. Djokovic did win five in a row twice, but skipped Monte Carlo and Madrid during those streaks, making Sinner's feat winning five he actually entered unique. The 24-year-old has now won 23 matches in a row, including titles at Indian Wells, Miami, Monte Carlo, and the Paris Masters from last year.

"I think there is a lot of work behind it. A lot of dedication and sacrifice I put in every day," Sinner said. "Obviously, it means a lot to me, seeing these results." He acknowledged that losses will come, but for now, his discipline and self-belief are paying off spectacularly.

The victory sets up a tantalizing clay-court season. Next week in Rome, Sinner can match Djokovic's career '**Golden Masters**' by winning all nine **Masters 1000** events. Then comes the French Open, where he lost a thrilling five-set final to Carlos Alcaraz last year. With Alcaraz withdrawing from Roland Garros due to a wrist injury, Sinner is the overwhelming favorite. A win in Paris would complete a **career Grand Slam**, making him only the 10th man to achieve the feat.

Sinner's dominance is staggering. He went 37 straight sets without dropping one on hard courts earlier this year, and hasn't lost a set since the third round in Monte Carlo. In Madrid, he was untouchable. Zverev, the world number three, had no answers for Sinner's **relentless baseline game** and **precision serving**.

As the tennis world watches, one question looms: can anyone stop Sinner's march? For now, the Italian is in a league of his own, turning every tournament into a victory lap.

Word Treasure

Masters 1000 -- The nine most important annual men's tennis tournaments after the four Grand Slams, awarding the winner 1000 ranking points.

break point -- A point in tennis where the receiver can win the game off the opponent's serve, breaking that serve.

Golden Masters -- A rare career achievement of winning all nine different Masters 1000 tournaments at least once; only Novak Djokovic has done it.

career Grand Slam -- Winning each of the four major tennis tournaments--Australian Open, French Open, Wimbledon, and US Open--at least once in a player's career.

relentless baseline game -- A style of play where a player constantly hits powerful, consistent shots from the back of the court, never giving the opponent an easy point.

precision serving -- Serving the ball with extreme accuracy, placing it exactly where the opponent finds it hardest to return.

Background you need

Jannik Sinner (born 2001) is an Italian tennis player who became world number one in 2024 and has rapidly risen to dominate the ATP Tour with his powerful groundstrokes and calm demeanor.

Alexander Zverev is a German player and former world number two who won the Madrid Open in 2018 and 2021, making him a two-time champion on that clay court.

Novak Djokovic, a 24-time Grand Slam champion from Serbia, is the only man to have completed the career Golden Masters--winning all nine Masters 1000 titles--and also holds the record for most Masters titles overall.

Carlos Alcaraz, a Spanish four-time major winner, defeated Sinner in a five-set French Open final in 2024, but a wrist injury forced him out of Roland Garros in 2025, removing one of Sinner's main obstacles.

The career Grand Slam is one of tennis's rarest honors: only nine men in the Open Era have achieved it, with legends like Roger Federer, Rafael Nadal, Novak Djokovic, and Andre Agassi among them.

Break it down

LEAD: Sinner rewriting record books

LATEST WIN: Madrid Open final -- demolished Zverev 6-1, 6-2 in 58 minutes

+ STATS: No break points faced, converted all four earned

HISTORIC FEAT: Fifth consecutive Masters 1000 title

+ COMPARISON: Surpassed Djokovic and Nadal (four each); Djokovic skipped events during his streaks

+ WIN STREAK: 23 matches, including Indian Wells, Miami, Monte Carlo, Paris

SINNER'S WORDS: Emphasizes hard work, dedication, and keeping perspective

+ QUOTE: 'Obviously, it means a lot to me, seeing these results'

WHAT'S NEXT: Rome chance to equal Golden Masters; French Open favorite

+ ALCARAZ OUT: Withdrawing from Roland Garros due to wrist injury

+ CAREER GRAND SLAM: A Paris win would make Sinner the 10th man to do it

DOMINANCE METRICS: 37 straight sets without dropping one on hard courts earlier; untouchable in Madrid

CLOSING QUESTION: Can anyone stop Sinner's march?

Why it matters

Sinner's historic streak shows how relentless discipline can reshape a sport, and his potential to complete a career Grand Slam this year could mark the beginning of a new era in tennis that young fans might witness from its first chapter.

Test what you remember

1. How many consecutive Masters 1000 titles has Jannik Sinner won after Madrid?

- ☐ (A) Three
- ☐ (B) Four
- ☐ (C) Five
- ☐ (D) Six

2. What was the score of the Madrid Open final?

- ☐ (A) 7-5, 6-3
- ☐ (B) 6-1, 6-2
- ☐ (C) 6-4, 6-4
- ☐ (D) 6-3, 6-3

3. What record could Sinner match if he wins the Rome tournament?

- ☐ (A) Most Grand Slam titles in a season
- ☐ (B) Novak Djokovic's career Golden Masters
- ☐ (C) Rafael Nadal's clay-court streak
- ☐ (D) Roger Federer's consecutive weeks at number one

4. Why is Sinner now considered the overwhelming favorite for the French Open?

- ☐ (A) He has never lost on clay
- ☐ (B) Carlos Alcaraz withdrew due to a wrist injury
- ☐ (C) The tournament was moved to hard courts
- ☐ (D) Djokovic announced retirement

5. How many matches has Sinner won in a row as of the Madrid final?

- ☐ (A) 15
- ☐ (B) 20
- ☐ (C) 23
- ☐ (D) 30

6. What would a French Open victory this year allow Sinner to achieve?

- ☐ (A) A career Golden Masters
- ☐ (B) The number one ranking for the first time
- ☐ (C) A career Grand Slam
- ☐ (D) His first Grand Slam title

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: B 3: B 4: B 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

- 1. Positive:** Sinner's dominance is the result of extraordinary dedication, turning him into a role model for young athletes. His clean, powerful game and humble attitude are winning over fans around the world and bringing fresh energy to the sport.
- 2. Negative / Critical:** His unchallenged run, boosted by Alcaraz's injury, raises fears that men's tennis could become predictable and less thrilling. A one-sided tour may hurt viewer interest if no rival consistently pushes him to a fifth set.
- 3. Neutral / Analytical:** Sinner's streak fits a historical pattern: tennis often sees dominant figures who raise the bar until new challengers emerge. The current gap partly stems from natural transitions between generations, as aging greats fade and young stars struggle with consistency.
- 4. Forward-looking:** If Sinner captures the French Open and completes the career Slam, the next question will be whether he can sustain this level to challenge Djokovic's longevity records and eventually join the 'GOAT' conversation, while the tour scrambles to find a counter-strategy.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):